Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 9 7 4
♥ 8
♦ A 6 3 2
♣ K Q J

♠ J
♥ A 6 5 4 3
♦ J 10 9 4
♣ 6 5 4

♠ 10 3
♥ Q 9 2
♦ K Q 8 7 5
♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2
♥ K J 10 7
♦ —
♣ A 9 8 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by North
Lead: ♦K

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 10 8 ♥ K 9 8 4 ♦ K 9 ♣ K 10 6 5	
♠ 3 2 ♥ J 3 2 ♦ 8 7 6 4 3 ♣ 8 4 3		♠ 9 7 6 5 4 ♥ Q 5 ♦ 10 5 2 ♣ A 7 2
	♠ K Q J ♥ A 10 7 6 ♦ A Q J ♣ Q J 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

5♥ by South
Lead: ♠3

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 7 ♥ K Q 9 8 5 ♦ K Q 7 4 ♣ 9 8 3	
♠ 10 9 8 6 4 ♥ 6 2 ♦ 10 8 3 ♣ J 5 2	N W E S	♠ 5 3 2 ♥ 4 3 ♦ J 9 6 2 ♣ A 7 6 4
	♠ A K Q J ♥ A J 10 7 ♦ A 5 ♣ K Q 10	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣A

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K 10 ♥ A K 9 8 4 ♦ K Q 8 ♣ K Q 6	
♠ 6 4 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ J 10 5 2 ♣ A 10 9 3	N W E S	♠ 9 8 2 ♥ Q 10 3 ♦ 9 7 6 ♣ J 7 5 4
	♠ A Q J 7 5 3 ♥ 6 5 ♦ A 4 3 ♣ 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦J

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6♠.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 7 6 4 2 ♥ K J 9 8 5 ♦ K Q 7 4 ♣ —	
♠ 10 9 8 ♥ 7 2 ♦ 3 2 ♣ K Q J 10 5 4	N W E S	♠ 5 3 ♥ 6 ♦ 10 9 6 5 ♣ A 9 8 6 3 2
	♠ A K Q J ♥ A Q 10 4 3 ♦ A J 8 ♣ 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♣	Pass	7♥
All Pass			

7♥ by North
Lead: ♣A

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, but you also have a void in ♣s. You therefore answer 6♣. Partner goes all the way to 7♥.

Board 6
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K 6 5 2 ♥ A Q 7 4 ♦ K 8 6 ♣ A Q	
♠ Q J 8 ♥ 5 3 2 ♦ A 9 7 ♣ 8 6 5 2	N W E S	♠ 4 3 ♥ 9 8 6 ♦ 5 4 2 ♣ 10 9 7 4 3
	♠ A 10 9 7 ♥ K J 10 ♦ Q J 10 3 ♣ K J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♠ by South
Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 15-17 points and 4 ♠s. You have 18 points and 4 ♠s. You plan to bid the slam, but first you check Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner says 5♣.

You are missing 1 Key-Card. Slam has become less certain. You decide to see if partner has the trump Queen so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 5♠. What do you say next?

Partner denies having the ♠Q. Knowing that the best you could hope for would be a finesse to make the slam you give up your quest and pass.